

AI Coding CLI Tools — Complete Industry Comparison

May 2026 · Claude Code Research Session

A comprehensive list of terminal-based AI coding agents — both company-driven and community-built — with token pricing, feature sets, and GitHub integration details. **BYOK** = Bring Your Own Key (tool is free; you pay the model provider directly).

Official / Company-Driven Tools

Claude Code (Anthropic)

Cost: Sonnet 4.6: \$3/\$15 per 1M tokens · Opus 4.8: \$5/\$25 per 1M · Max subscription: \$200/mo

Features:

- File read/write, shell execution, multi-agent fan-out
- MCP server support, plan mode, extended thinking (Opus only)
- Hooks and automation, IDE extensions (VS Code, JetBrains)
- SWE-bench Verified: 79.6% (Sonnet 4.6)

GitHub integration: PR creation, PR review, issue reference, auto-commit with message generation, branch awareness

Install: `npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code`

OpenAI Codex CLI (OpenAI)

Cost: GPT-5.5: \$5/\$30 per 1M tokens · Included in ChatGPT Pro (\$200/mo)

Features:

- File read/write, shell execution, sandboxed execution
- Parallel subagents, MCP support
- Built-in code review agent before commit
- SWE-bench Verified: 88.7%

GitHub integration: PR creation, diff review, branch operations, auto-commit

Install: `npm i -g @openai/codex` OR `brew install --cask codex`

~75K GitHub stars · ~3M weekly active users

Gemini CLI (Google)

Cost: Free tier: 1,000 req/day, 1M token context, no card required · Paid API: \$2/\$12 per 1M

Features:

- File edit, shell commands, web search built-in
- MCP servers, ReAct loop, open-source weekly releases
- Runs Gemini 2.5 Pro · 1M token context window
- SWE-bench Verified: 80.6%

GitHub integration: PR creation, diff review, commit generation

Install: `npm install -g @google/gemini-cli`

Free-tier users transitioning to Antigravity CLI on June 18, 2026

Grok Build (xAI)

Cost: SuperGrok subscription: \$299/mo (or \$99/mo promo) · API: \$0.20/\$1.50 per 1M (grok-build-0.1)

Features:

- Up to 8 parallel subagents on larger tasks
- Plan-first loop — approves plan before executing
- MCP support · reads existing Claude Code MCP config
- Headless CI mode · 256K context window
- SWE-bench Verified: 70.8%

GitHub integration: PR creation, branch management, auto-commit

Install: Beta — access via SuperGrok / X Premium+ subscription

macOS and Linux native · Windows via WSL2 · Native Win32 on roadmap

Community / Open-Source Tools

Aider

Maintainer: Paul Gauthier (independent) · **GitHub Stars:** ~41K

Cost: BYOK — free tool, pay only your model API costs. Works with any OpenAI-compatible endpoint.

Features:

- Tree-sitter repo map across 100+ languages
- Auto-commits with descriptive messages
- Multi-file edits, voice coding mode, /run shell integration
- Works in any editor — no IDE plugin required

GitHub integration: Git-native auto-commits, branch creation, diff management. No native PR creation — integrates cleanly with the gh CLI.

Install: `pip install aider-chat`

OpenCode

Maintainer: Community (OpenAI partnership) · **GitHub Stars:** ~120–150K (fastest-growing)

Cost: Free and open-source. Supports 75+ providers — use GitHub Copilot or ChatGPT Plus auth, or raw API keys.

Features:

- LSP integration — automatically configures language servers for the LLM
- Multi-session parallel agents on the same project
- Session sharing via links · desktop app + IDE extension variants
- 75+ provider support

GitHub integration: Auto-commit, PR creation, diff review

Install: `npm install -g opencode`

After Anthropic's January 2026 enforcement, Claude requires raw API key (not OAuth)

Goose (Block → Linux Foundation)

Maintainer: Donated to Linux Foundation Agentic AI Foundation, April 2026 · **GitHub Stars:** ~32K

Cost: Free (Apache 2.0). BYOK — pay your model provider.

Features:

- Full agent loop: installs deps, runs tests, edits files, fixes failures

- CLI + desktop app
- MCP extensions, built in Rust

GitHub integration: Auto-commit, branch operations — no native PR creation

Install: `brew install goose` OR binary from GitHub Releases

Continue (Continue.dev)

Maintainer: Continue.dev (VC-backed startup) · **GitHub Stars:** ~31K

Cost: Free core (Apache 2.0). Cloud team features on paid plans. BYOK for models.

Features:

- Originally IDE extension (VS Code/JetBrains) — now also has cn terminal agent
- 200+ model configurations, inline autocomplete
- Codebase indexing

GitHub integration: Commit suggestions, diff integration — deeper on the IDE side than terminal side

Install: `npm install -g continuedev`

Cline

Maintainer: Community · **GitHub Stars:** ~58K

Cost: Free (Apache 2.0). BYOK.

Features:

- VS Code extension + CLI mode
- Multi-provider support, tool calling
- Browser automation, MCP servers

GitHub integration: PR review, auto-commit, branch operations

Install: VS Code extension marketplace or CLI binary

OpenHands (formerly OpenDevin)

Maintainer: All-Hands AI (VC-backed) · **GitHub Stars:** ~68K

Cost: Free self-hosted (MIT). Cloud platform pricing on request.

Features:

- Full software-engineer agent: browses web, writes and runs code, manages git
- Web UI + lightweight CLI binary
- Docker or pip install

GitHub integration: Native PR creation and review, issue triage, branch management — strongest GitHub integration of any open-source tool

Install: Docker or `pip install openhands` · CLI: `openhands-cli` binary

DeepSeek-TUI

Maintainer: Community (not affiliated with DeepSeek officially) · **GitHub Stars:** Early-stage

Cost: BYOK DeepSeek API — \$0.44/\$1.74 per 1M (V4 Pro). Dramatically low cost.

Features:

- Rust binary — fast startup
- Tool calling, auto subagents, sandboxed execution

- MCP support, persistent task queue, TUI interface

GitHub integration: Auto-commit — limited native PR support

Install: `npm install -g deepseek-tui`

■ *API calls route to China-hosted servers — data-residency concerns apply*

Crush (Charmbracelet)

Maintainer: Charmbracelet (makers of Bubble Tea, Glow) · **GitHub Stars:** N/A

Cost: Free (open-source). BYOK multi-provider.

Features:

- Glamorous TUI in Go
- Multi-provider: Claude, GPT, Gemini, Ollama (local)
- MCP support, keyboard-driven interface

GitHub integration: Auto-commit — lightweight git integration

Install: `brew install charmbracelet/tap/crush`

Plandex

Maintainer: Community · **GitHub Stars:** N/A

Cost: Free self-hosted. Plandex Cloud is winding down.

Features:

- Plan-first agent — reviews plan before applying
- Up to 2M token context window
- Diff-review sandbox before applying changes
- Built for long, multi-step tasks

GitHub integration: Diff review, branch operations — no active development on PR features

Install: Self-hosted only

■ *No commits since October 2025 — effectively maintenance mode*

At-a-Glance Summary

Tool	Driven By	Input \$/1M	Free Tier	Multi-Agent	MCP	GitHub PRs
Claude Code	Anthropic	\$3–\$5	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Codex CLI	OpenAI	\$5	No (\$200/mo plan)	Yes	Yes	Yes
Gemini CLI	Google	\$2	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Grok Build	xAI	\$0.20	No (subscription)	Yes (8)	Yes	Yes
Aider	Community	BYOK	Yes	No	No	Via gh CLI
OpenCode	Community	BYOK	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Goose	Linux Foundation	BYOK	Yes	Limited	Yes	Partial
Continue	Continue.dev	BYOK	Yes	Limited	Yes	IDE-side
Cline	Community	BYOK	Yes	No	Yes	Yes

Tool	Driven By	Input \$/1M	Free Tier	Multi-Agent	MCP	GitHub PRs
OpenHands	All-Hands AI	BYOK	Yes (self-host)	Yes	Yes	Best in class
DeepSeek-TUI	Community	\$0.44	Yes	Yes	Yes	Partial
Crush	Charmbracelet	BYOK	Yes	No	Yes	Partial
Plandex	Community	BYOK	Yes (self-host)	No	No	Partial

BYOK = Bring Your Own Key — tool is free, you pay the model provider directly.

Sources

- Every AI Coding CLI in 2026: 30+ Tools — <https://dev.to/soulentheo/every-ai-coding-cli-in-2026-the-complete-map-30-tools-compared-4gob>
- Awesome CLI Coding Agents — GitHub — <https://github.com/bradAGI/awesome-cli-coding-agents>
- OpenAI Codex CLI — GitHub — <https://github.com/openai/codex>
- Gemini CLI — Google Developers — <https://developers.google.com/gemini-code-assist/docs/gemini-cli>
- Grok Build — xAI — <https://x.ai/news/grok-build-cli>
- OpenHands CLI — GitHub — <https://github.com/OpenHands/OpenHands-CLI>
- Best Open Source CLI Agents 2026 — Pinggy — https://pinggy.io/blog/best_open_source_cli_coding_agents/
- 15 AI Coding CLI Tools Compared — Tembo — <https://www.tembo.io/blog/coding-cli-tools-comparison>
- Aider — Official Site — <https://aider.chat/>
- SWE-Bench Leaderboard May 2026 — <https://www.marc0.dev/en/leaderboard>